

Platner may win, but primary still a test

Maine’s Democratic Senate contest could reflect resilience of his support

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

BANGOR, Maine — For populist insurgent Graham Platner, Maine’s Senate primary election had been shaping up as a coronation. All of a sudden, it’s looking more

like a test.

When Maine Democrats’ ballots are counted on Tuesday, Platner remains all but certain to become their nominee to take on Republican Senator Susan Collins, given that his top rival, Governor Janet Mills, suspended her campaign in

April.

But after the events of the last two weeks, during which Platner faced fresh damaging allegations about his past conduct, the primary contest is now serving as a potentially revealing data point for how effectively he is weathering the scrutiny and consolidating support.

Mills remains on the primary ballot — a fact she has reminded Democratic voters of in recent days

— as does a third candidate, David Costello, who has been actively campaigning but has not picked up remotely as much traction as Platner. Some Maine Democrats have said they still intend to vote for Mills even though her campaign has been inactive.

The question now is how many primary voters actually cast a ballot for someone other than Platner, and

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Julian Whyte is nonverbal and has severe disabilities. He attends the Henderson School in Dorchester, which is closing.

Reconfiguring special education

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

When Julian Whyte gets off the school bus in Mattapan to head home in his wheelchair, he waves goodbye to his friends. The 10-year-old can’t talk much, but he is a social butterfly, posing for selfies and flipping his baseball cap backward for laughs.

Julian wasn’t always happy. For six years at Blackstone Elementary, he was a gloomier child, said his mother, Meshell Whyte. The South End school wasn’t able to teach him

Parents fear Boston’s new approach may be leaving out the kids who need help the most

alongside other children, so he often learned alone in a separate classroom, which was “crushing him,” Whyte said.

Last year, Julian enrolled at Dorchester’s renowned Henderson School, where he has begun to excel while learning with other students.

“Now my son can write his name for the first time without guidance,” Whyte said.

The Henderson was once hailed as a model of inclusive education, drawing scholars

SPECIAL ED, Page A7

Hopefuls say no to releasing tax return

Voters kept in dark despite pledges of transparency by gubernatorial candidates

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey once vowed to bring more transparency to her office “than ever before.” The two Republicans hoping to unseat her recently rallied a crowd of thousands with calls for a more open government.

But when asked to open a window into their own books, all three clammed up.

The three major party candidates for governor refused requests from the Globe to disclose five years’ worth of their personal tax returns, a denial made all the more notable as their personal wealth and demands for transparency are animating this race.

Disclosing personal financial details isn’t required by Massachusetts law, but many politicians have provided the documents when running for higher office, Healey once being among them. The tax returns can provide insight into the money they have available to shape their ability to get their message out to voters.

They could, and have in the past, also shed light on any potential conflicts of interest in where they earn their money, where candidates have called home, or, as they debate how residents should be taxed, what they themselves pay to the govern-

TAX RETURNS, Page A10

Late-night public pints get approved

Healey signs bill for 3 a.m. last call through July

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts lawmakers on Monday embraced a proposal that would allow bars to serve alcohol until 3 a.m. and permit fans to imbibe in designated public spaces through the end of July in a bid to capitalize on the slate of World Cup matches the state is hosting.

The Massachusetts House and Senate voted to send Governor Maura Healey the bill Monday afternoon and she signed it, five days before FIFA World Cup matches begin in Foxborough.

The proposal’s passage, put on the relative fast track through Beacon Hill just last week, was briefly gummed up in the legislative gears Monday after the state House and Senate initially disagreed on key details around letting booze flow more freely in the coming months.

Healey had already said she supported allowing Massachusetts bars and restaurants to remain open until 3 a.m. this summer, and loosening the state’s drinking laws, at least temporarily. On Instagram on Monday, the governor reposted a story about whether she would sign the bill, set to Post Malone’s song, “Pour Me A Drink.”

“This bill will provide more opportunities for people to celebrate with their community for the World Cup and the other exciting events we have happening this summer for MA250,” Healey said in a statement after signing the bill.

The push to allow for more pints, however, hasn’t been universally embraced. Boston’s service workers have fretted that the extended hours could

LAST CALL, Page A10

ROBERT COLES 1928-2026

His work helped us better understand children and race

By David M. Shribman
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Robert Coles — psychologist and poet, social historian and social critic, Christian existentialist and intellectual entrepreneur — has died. He was 97.

He died Thursday at a hospice center in Lincoln, according to numerous reports.

Dr. Coles won international renown, and a Pulitzer Prize, for his work on the inner lives of children and won the admiration, and lifelong mentorship, of Harvard undergraduates he taught in “General Education 105: Literature of Social Reflection,” a course students sometimes labeled “Guilt 105” that routinely attracted more than 800 students. The author of more than 50 books, he sometimes was known on the Cambridge campus as Robert “Never an Unpublished Thought” Coles.

But Dr. Coles’s thoughts came with a quiet passion and a stunning velocity that shook the worlds of medicine and education, civil rights, and American civic life.

“He added greatly to our understanding of children and the world they live in,” said Judith Palfrey, chief of the division of general pediatrics at Children’s Hospital Boston for more than two decades and a professor of pediatrics at Harvard Medical School. “He taught students of all ages through his books, and he studied the social determinants of health long before it became an important topic in popular conversation. He made these issues very accessible.”

Dr. Coles did so while helping to reinvent the

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A FAREWELL FOR FRANK



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Jim Ready paused while speaking about his husband, Barney Frank, during a memorial service Monday for the legendary liberal lawmaker. Scores of dignitaries and constituents attended the service at Faneuil Hall. B1.



Sun tan notion

Tuesday: Warmer, breezy. High 84-89, low 62-67.

Wednesday: Shower late.

Weather and comics, D5-6.

Police in seaside towns are on alert for beach takeovers by unruly youths, part of a nationwide trend that involves mass gatherings planned on social media, often with the intent of causing chaos. B1.

Iran and Israel halted their exchange of missiles but both warned they stood ready to strike each other again. A3.

Birth rates are falling in countries

across the world. Researchers say they have a new suspect: smart-phones. A2.

Hiring has kicked back into gear, even in Massachusetts, but key sectors are not benefiting. Trend-lines, D1.

President Trump nominated acting attorney general Todd Blanche, his former personal lawyer, to take the position permanently. A6.

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